world capitalist system to continue with expansion of binding business contracts, their enforcement and the extraction of adequate flows of materials (as well as workers) from distant sites that remain critical to the smooth functioning of the world division of labour.

Fourth, as Sam Moyo and Paris Yeros (2011:19) put it, imperialism's relations with sub-imperial allies always entailed 'the *super-exploitation* of domestic labour. It was natural, therefore, that, as it grew, it would require external markets for the resolution of its profit realisation crisis.' Concretely, to take BRICS as an example, super-exploitative relations are witnessed in the way that Chinese households are torn from rural land during the ongoing urbanisation process, and in the broader context in which rural people require special work permits to live in cities where they are paid much lower wages. Such super-exploitative relations are then readily transferred to the international scale, where China's role has been even more predatory than that of Western corporations, backed by its support of local dictators (e.g. the case of Zimbabwe where Chinese military and Zimbabwean generals conjoined as the Anjin Corporation in the world's largest diamond fields, with a resulting resource curse as extreme as any in contemporary Africa) (Maguwu 2013).

Likewise, South Africa's historical mode of apartheid super-exploitation – termed 'articulations of modes of production' by Harold Wolpe (1980) – exemplified the most extreme internal dimension of sub-imperial accumulation. Migrant male workers from rural Bantustans as well as regional hinterlands as far north as Malawi long provided 'cheap labour', thanks to black rural women's unpaid reproduction of children, sick workers and retirees generally without state support. This was not merely a matter of formal racial power. The expansion of the South African migrancy model much deeper into the Southern African region in the wake of apartheid's early 1990s demise occurred notwithstanding tragic xenophobic reactions from the local working class that continue to this day. The August 2012 Marikana massacre of striking migrant platinum mineworkers at Lonmin was another example of how far the regime's policing function would go internally so as to defend the profitability of multinational extractive corporations (Saul and Bond 2014).

But it is the inexorable regional-hinterland expansion of these processes that compels sub-imperial states to follow the logic of imperialism. This is recognised by professional geopoliticians of capital, such as the Texas intelligence firm Stratfor (2009), in an internal memo (as revealed by WikiLeaks): 'South Africa's history is driven by the interplay of competition and cohabitation between domestic and foreign interests exploiting the country's mineral resources. Despite being led